

Dillon Colbert

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Education

New York University

MS Urban Data Science – Tandon School of Engineering, Center for Urban Science + Progress

New York, NY

May 2028

- Notable Courses: *URPL-GP 2631* - Transportation, Land Use, & Urban Form; *TR-GY 6053* - Policy in Urban & Transport Systems

Washington University

BS Environmental Engineering, Minor in Energy Engineering – McKelvey School of Engineering

St. Louis, MO

May 2025

- Notable Courses: *MUD 652H* - Metropolitan Development: What's in a Plan?; *ENST 4527* - IPCC: Governance, Policy & Science

National University Singapore

International Experience in Energy, Environmental, and Chemical Engineering

Singapore

Jun 2023

- Attended lectures and industry tours in engineering, learning about cutting-edge urban greening, transport systems, and air quality
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Experience

Freelance Writer – Urban Policy

Streetsblog USA, NextSTL

Remote

Feb 2026 – Present

- Published “Chicago to St. Louis Is the High-Speed Rail Test America Can’t Afford to Fail” for the national transportation journal, *Streetsblog*, to bring awareness to a strengthening movement for high-speed rail in the United States
- For *NextSTL*, a development, transportation, and public policy journal in St. Louis, I published “The Case for Accessory Commercial Units in St. Louis” to locally apply my housing research on incremental/small-scale development

Community Design Researcher

Washington University, Sam Fox School of Design & Visual Arts

Gateway South Redevelopment, St. Louis, MO

Mar 2025 – Mar 2026

- Analyzed built environment barriers (highways, industry, vacancy) to evaluate (dis)connectivity, producing 50+ historical vs. present block comparisons using state archives, personal photography, and Google Street View

Fall Intern

Citizens for Modern Transit

St. Louis, MO

Sep – Dec 2025

- Quantified vacancies on future transit corridors with GIS to convey transit-oriented development potential to policymakers
- Cleaned datasets of redundant/untrimmed user entries with Excel’s power query + SQL to prepare for transit agency use

Sustainability Consultant

City of Ferguson

Ferguson, MO

Jan – May 2025

- Conducted interviews with civic leaders and citizens to draft an engagement plan following the 2014 Ferguson crisis

Building Decarbonization Intern

Midwest Climate Collaborative (MCC), Washington University Office of Sustainability

St. Louis, MO

May – Dec 2024

- Performed energy audits and managed data for 200+ CBO properties to decarbonize low-income, multifamily housing in the region
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Leadership & Activities

STL Urbanists, Strong Towns St. Louis

Conversation Leader

St. Louis, MO

Jun 2025 – Present

- Organize social media campaigns on local built-environment problems, primarily highway removal and parking reform
- ArcGIS Pro analysis to map transit metrics (ridership per mile, on-time performance) and calculate parking ratios like those from the Parking Reform Network

WashU Urbanists – Washington University Transportation and Mobility Club

President

St. Louis, MO

Jul 2024 – May 2025

- Led initiatives showcasing the fabric of St. Louis via active transport to improve student engagement, mitigate brain drain
 - Added 40 members, raised event attendance from 0-3 to 15-20, upgraded the funding category, and strengthened partnerships with other clubs and local nonprofits, significantly expanding the footprint and operating capacity of the organization
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Awards & Interests

Awards: CityStudioSTL Fellowship, Honors in Innovation & Entrepreneurship, SP2025 Dean’s List

Interests/Hobbies: Music, urban history, neighborhood walks, libraries, parks, sports: soccer, baseball, basketball, running

Technical Skills: GIS (advanced), Microsoft Office (advanced), Adobe Suite, CAD, MATLAB, R, Python, SketchUp